

ZONING BOARD OF APPEALS

Charlotte Dewey
Ronald Smith
Frank Carcio
Vacant – Associate member

Term Expires 2022
Term Expires 2023
Term Expires 2024
Term Expires 2023

Town Calendar

2022

January 1	New Year's Day
January 1	Dog licenses available from the Town Clerk
January 18	Martin Luther King Day
February 15	Presidents Day
March 31	Last day to purchase a dog license without a late fee
April 19	Last day to submit nomination papers to the Town Clerk for local election
May 13	Last day to register to vote in the local elections and annual town meeting
May 24	Annual Town Local Elections and Annual Town Meeting
May 30	Memorial Day
June 20	Juneteenth
July 4	Fourth of July
August 17	Last day to register to vote in the State Primary
September 5	Labor Day
September 6	State Primary
October 10	Columbus Day
October 19	Last day to register to vote in the State Election
November 8	State Election
November 11	Veteran's Day
November 25	Thanksgiving
December 25	Christmas

ANNUAL TOWN ELECTION
May 25, 2021
TOWN FIRE STATION, FACTORY ROAD
12:00 P.M. (NOON) TO 7:00 P.M.

The polls opened at 12:00 P.M. (noon). The ballot box was inspected by Police Officer Benjamin Duga to ensure the box was empty of ballots and the counter was set at 0 (zero). Poll workers were Lydia Cannon, Brian Cannon, Kathryn Hallanbeck, Lynda Reynolds, Patricia Stafford, Mary Stafford, Tracy Hall and Linda DuPree. Linda Wagner and Marian Noga oversaw the elections as Wardens. The Police Officer during the Elections was Benjamin Duga and Constable Erwin Reynolds, Jr. (who volunteered his time). Seventy-eight ballots were cast.

The polls closed at 7:00 P.M. The election results are as follows:

<u>SELECT BOARD</u>	<u>3 years</u>	<u>MODERATOR</u>	<u>1 year</u>
Daniel J Girard	67 votes	Charlotte Dewey	11 votes
Blanks	11 votes	Robert Handsater	2 votes
<u>BOARD OF ASSESSORS</u>	<u>3 YEARS</u>	Blanks	65 votes
Anthony Ostroski	4 votes	<u>PLANNING BOARD</u>	<u>5 years</u>
Blanks	74 votes	Robert Nelson	65 votes
<u>CHARLEMONT SCH. COMM</u>	<u>3 years</u>	Blanks	13 votes
Michael Walsh	12 votes	<u>PLANNING BOARD</u>	<u>6 YEARS</u>
Blanks	66 votes	Daniel Miller	2 votes
<u>MOHAWK SCHOOL COMM</u>	<u>3 years</u>	Blanks	76 votes
Charles Ricko	1 vote	<u>BOARD OF HEALTH</u>	<u>3 years</u>
Michael Walsh	1 vote	Douglas Telling	58 votes
Camille White	1 vote	Blank	20 votes
Blanks	75 votes	<u>PARK & RECREATION COM</u>	<u>5 years</u>
<u>LOCAL ED. COUNCIL</u>	<u>3 years</u>	Michael Hayden	10 votes
Mary Ledwell	1 vote	Blank	68 votes
Blanks	77 votes	<u>PARK & RECREATION COM</u>	<u>4 years</u>
<u>CONSTABLE</u>	<u>3 years</u>	Jacqueline Cashin	67 votes
Jared Bellows	5 votes	Blank	11 votes
Blanks	73 votes	<u>PARK & RECREATION COM</u>	<u>1 year</u>
<u>TYLER LIBRARY TRUSTEE</u>	<u>3 years</u>	Neil Neuhauser	63 votes
Esther Haskell	71 votes	Blank	15 votes
Blanks	7 votes	Respectfully submitted	Kathy A. Reynolds Town Clerk

MINUTES OF THE ANNUAL TOWN MEETING
June 12, 2021 1:00 P.M.
Charlemont Fairgrounds
Park Street

Moderator Charlotte Dewey commenced the Annual Town Meeting at 1:00 P.M. The Moderator announced that the warrant was signed and posted in the proper time frame and manner. A quorum of 10 voters were present. Officials at the head tables were introduced. Finance Committee members Amy Wales and Richard Filoramo were re-appointed to the Finance Committee. Jason Antes was thanked for providing the sound system for the afternoon. A list of residents who had passed away was read.

Article 1: Voted to accept the Report of the Town Officers.

Passed unanimously.

Article 2: Voted to authorize the Select Board to apply for and accept any and all Federal and State grants or gifts from individuals or non-profit organizations which may become available during the fiscal year 2022.

Passed unanimously.

Article 3: Voted to authorize the Treasurer to enter into a compensating balance agreement or agreements for fiscal year 2022, pursuant to Chapter 44, Section 53F of the Massachusetts General Laws.

Passed unanimously.

Article 4: Voted, pursuant to the provisions of General Laws Chapter 44, s53E1/2, to establish the following Revolving Fund and to amend Section III of the Town Bylaws by adding the following text:

REVOLVING FUND	AUTHORITY TO SPEND FUND	REVENUE SOURCES	USE OF FUNDS
Parks & Recreation Revolving Fund	Parks & Recreation Commission	User and rental fees	Maintenance of Town Parks

And, further, to establish the following spending limit for such funds for Fiscal Year 2022:

1. Dog Fund = \$2,500.00
2. Recycling = \$6,000.00
3. Flags and Banners = \$1,200.00
4. Fire Inspection = \$1,200.00
5. Planning Board = \$950.00
6. Parks & Recreation Commission - \$6,000.00

Passed unanimously.



Franklin County Sheriff's Office Regional Dog Shelter

10 Sandy Lane, Turners Falls, MA 01376

413-676-9182

www.fcrdogkennel.org

2021 ANNUAL REPORT

TO THE SELECT BOARD AND RESIDENTS OF CHARLEMONT:

The Franklin County Sheriff's Office Regional Dog Shelter has been in operation since 2012. The shelter was started by Sheriff Christopher Donelan who saw the need in the community for a dog sheltering facility. As of this date, the dog shelter provides services to 22 of the 26 Franklin County towns.

During the course of 2021, the Regional Dog Shelter logged 157 canine intakes.

104 where brought in as strays, and 53 where Surrendered, Transferred or Returned adoptions to our facility.

What happened to the dogs?

- 🐾 80 where returned to their owners.
- 🐾 50 where adopted into new fur-ever homes.
- 🐾 9 where transferred to another facility to better meet their specific needs.
- 🐾 10 where sadly euthanized by an attending veterinarian. Euthanasia is not something we take lightly and we do our best to explore all available options before choosing this course of action. Of these 10, (4) where owner intended euthanasia; (2) where medically compromised; (4) where euthanized for severe aggression towards people and other animals.

While we are primarily a dog facility with the addition of the Sheriff's Office Regional Animal Control Position the shelter assisted in the holding and transfer of 33 cats. At this time, the shelter does not have the capability to process cat adoptions, therefore all cats are transferred to an appropriate agency.

Food Pantries: During the Covid-19 Pandemic, the Shelter has worked to supply pet food into local food pantries for residents who are in needed. If you are struggling to feed your pet, or know of a food pantry that could use dog/cat food please let us know!

Rabies Clinics: In 2021, the shelter partnered with (2) local veterinarians to sponsor rabies clinics in Turners Falls, Heath, and Shelburne Falls. Between these (3) clinics, a total of 86 pets where vaccinated against rabies.

Dog Licensing: Some Town Clerks have granted the ability for the shelter to issue a dog license for a dog that was brought in and not licensed. As Massachusetts General Law requires every dog be licensed and vaccinated for rabies before it can be released from the shelter. This ability has drastically reduced the time that an owned dog must stay at the shelter, if it was unlicensed upon intake.

Volunteers: Volunteers are essential to the smooth operation of the shelter, without them, we would not have the success that we have today, during 2021 our volunteers logged 4,777 volunteer hours! Our volunteers assist the operation of the shelter by helping with Daily Kennel Chores, Foster Homes, Event Staffing and providing Enrichment specific to each dog's needs. We are always in need of new volunteers, if you are interested in joining our volunteer team; please check out the volunteer application on our website.

Did you know? The overall average length of stay for a dog at our kennel is 30 days? During this time, all their costs and care are covered by the Friends of the Franklin County Regional Dog Shelter.

SPECIAL TOWN ELECTION

AUGUST 3, 2021

HAWLEMONT REGIONAL ELEMENTARY SCHOOL

12:00 P.M. (NOON) TO 7:00 P.M.

The polls opened at 12:00 P.M. (noon). The ballot box was inspected by Police Officer Jason Pelletier to ensure the box was empty of ballots and the counter was set at 0 (zero). Poll workers were Lydia Cannon, Brian Cannon, Kathryn Hallanbeck, Lynda Reynolds, Patricia Stafford, Mary Stafford, Tracy Hall and Linda DuPree. Linda Wagner and Marian Noga oversaw the elections as Wardens. The Police Officer during the Elections was Jason Pelletier and Constable Erwin Reynolds, Jr. (who volunteered his time). All votes were for write in candidates.

One hundred and sixteen ballots were cast. One provisional ballot was submitted. The polls closed at 7:00 P.M. The election results are as follows:

SELECT BOARD 10 MONTHS

William Harker	63 votes - accepted
Valentine Reid	42 votes
Sarah LaValley	4 votes
Marjorie Porrovecchio	1 vote
Ronald Smith	1 vote
Kenneth Hall	1 vote
Ronald Scott	1 vote
Charlie Ricko	1 vote
Blanks	2

TREE WARDEN 1 YEAR, 10 MONTHS

Timothy Eichholz	39 votes – declined
Andrew Mueller	17 votes
Joseph Purinton	8 votes
Nathaniel Bellows	4 votes
Robert Jillson	2 votes
Stephen Reynolds	2 votes
William Coli	2 votes
Lori Hicks	1 vote
Jared Bellows	1 vote
Gordon Hathaway	1 vote
Erwin Reynolds	1 vote
Douglas Annear	1 vote
Stephen Thayer	1 vote
Eric Dean	1 vote
Valentine Reid	1 vote
Glen Dean	1 vote
Nelson Lanoue	1 vote
Blanks	32
Respectfully submitted	Kathy A. Reynolds Town Clerk

Superintendent of Schools Town Report - 2021

It is a pleasure and honor to continue serving as your Superintendent of Schools. We have completed our strategic plan and are excited to move the work of both districts forward. Even though COVID 19 continues to dominate our landscape, shape our interactions, and sense of “normal”, we have worked together to make our schools and our community as safe as possible throughout the lingering pandemic. I am thankful for the empathy our community shares for each other as this has allowed us to traverse the many challenges of both districts while remaining focused on providing the most outstanding educational experience for our students.

We returned to part time in-person learning in the spring and full time in-person learning this fall. With additional protocols and safety measures, staff welcomed students and our collective enthusiasm was overwhelming! It was so amazing to have our students back in the buildings and hear their laughter and joy fill the hallways. The school districts have continued to focus on improving our technology infrastructure for in-person instruction. Our capital improvement projects have begun, including upgrades and repairs to ventilation and heating systems that have been long overdue. Thank you to the Capital Improvement Working Group for their time and thoughtful approach to ensuring our schools receive the needed attention and repairs, especially during COVID 19. We are extremely appreciative and thankful for this work and look forward to additional projects that will be completed this summer.

MTRSD planned and facilitated the Rural Schools Round Table this fall. Senator Adam Hinds and Representative Natalie Blais, both key legislators on the Student Opportunity Act Rural Commission presented and participated. Our neighboring districts attended and shared with the rest of the Rural Commission the long-standing concerns and issues inherent in educating students in rural communities. Significant rural aid has been added to the state budget, however, we continue to pursue legislative changes to create permanent funding for schools in rural communities. Thank you to the community members who attended, participated, and advocated passionately and effectively during the Rural Round Table event. Our work is essential in supporting the unique needs of students, families, schools, and our communities to ensure and sustain high quality, equitable education for small and rural districts.

In addition to continuing our implementation of the Bridges Math Program, literacy is a key focus for both districts. We are working with the Massachusetts Department of Elementary and Secondary Education to choose a scientifically, evidence-based literacy curriculum. Our District Literacy Leadership Team has been working hard to pilot curriculum, participate in professional development, and collaborate as a district to ensure literacy instruction is consistent throughout the district. We are very thankful for our partnership with the Mary Lyon Foundation in sharing our work with the community as well. Our partnership has included providing a literacy basket for any newborn in our towns as well as books for every preschool student in our district. These are exciting initiatives that bring our community together around the importance of literacy for everyone in our learning community.

A third key curriculum priority in all schools continues to be social-emotional learning. Our ESSER II and III funding has been allocated to additional support personnel and community engagement and enrichment programming. These are essential in developing and sustaining positive relationships with staff and peers as students return to in-person learning. Much of what students know about school has changed over the past year so now more than ever, it is critical that students know they are cared for and belong to a welcoming community.